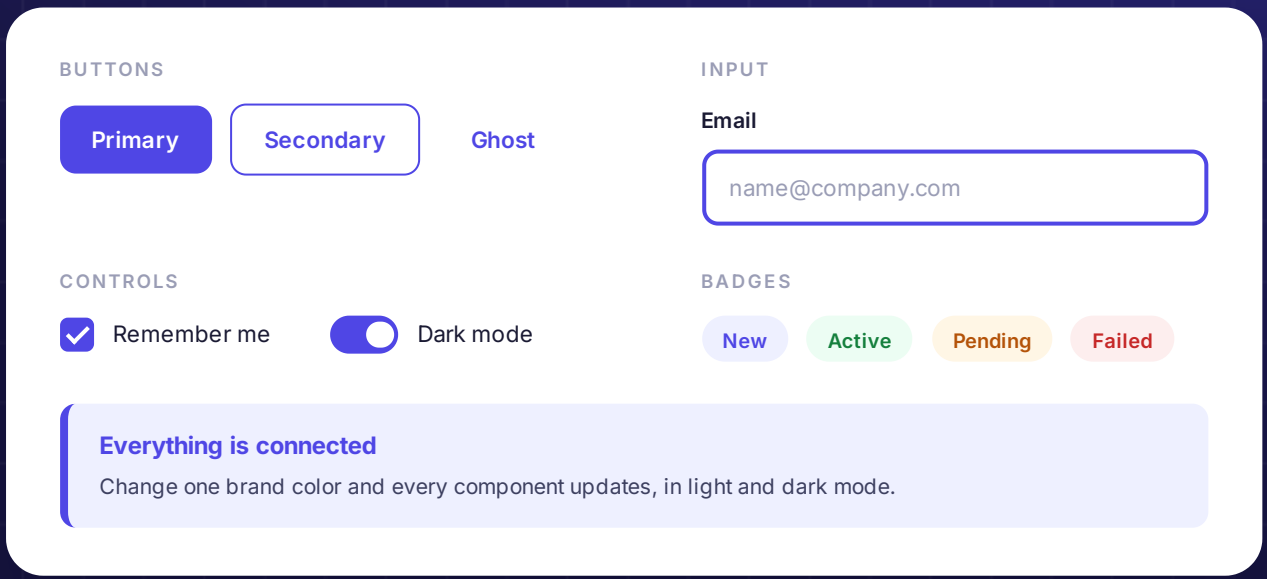
A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE FOR DESIGNERS

Build your Figma design system in ten minutes

Colors, text styles, spacing and eight ready components, created automatically by a small plugin. No drawing by hand, no coding needed.



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OVERVIEW

What you'll end up with

Think of the plugin as a recipe: give it to Figma once, and Figma builds the whole system. Every piece uses the same saved colors and sizes, so one change updates everything.

Colors

Brand, neutral, success, warning and danger, each with Light and Dark versions.

Text styles

10 sizes: Display, Headings H1 to H3, Body and Label in three sizes.

Spacing and corners

Fixed gaps from 4 to 48 px, and corner roundness from square to fully round.

Button

Primary, Secondary, Ghost, Danger in three sizes, with Normal, Hover and Disabled looks.

Input field

Label, text box and hint, in Normal, Typing, Error and Disabled looks.

Checkbox and Radio

Ticked or unticked, normal or disabled, with an editable label.

Toggle switch

The on/off slider for settings screens, normal or disabled.

Badge

Small rounded tags in grey, blue, green, yellow and red.

Alert

Message boxes for info, success, warning and errors.

Card

Image area, title, short text and a button, with parts you can switch off.

BEFORE YOU START

You need three things

No coding knowledge is needed. You will only download files and click menus.

- [ ] **The Figma desktop app.** The plugin does not run in Figma in the browser. Download it free from figma.com/downloads.

- [ ] **The two plugin files from Claude:** `code.js` and `manifest.json`, from the "DS Builder – Components" version.

- [ ] **A quick plan check.** Everything works on the free plan, with two limits: Dark mode needs a paid plan (it's skipped automatically on free), and sharing the library with other files needs a Professional plan or higher.

01 STEP ONE · 2 MINUTES Download and organise the files

Put both files together in one folder, with their names unchanged.

1. Create a new folder on your computer, for example on your Desktop, and name it **DS Builder Components**.
2. Download `code.js` and `manifest.json` from the Claude chat.
3. Move both files into the folder. It should look like this:

```
DS Builder Components/
   ├── code.js
   └── manifest.json
```

IMPORTANT Keep the names exactly as they are. `manifest.json` tells Figma to look for a file called `code.js`, so renaming either one breaks the plugin.

NOTE If you have the older "DS Builder" plugin from the first round, you no longer need it. The Components plugin now creates everything by itself.

02 STEP TWO Change the brand colors and fonts OPTIONAL

Skip this on your first try. The plugin comes with a clean blue-and-grey default, so you can see how everything works before using your own brand.

Easiest way

Send Claude your brand colors (hex codes like `#4F46E5`) and your font name. Claude returns an updated `code.js` that you swap into your folder.

Do it yourself

Edit the hex codes in `code.js` with any text editor, following the four steps below. Takes about 5 minutes.

1. Open `code.js` in a plain text editor: Notepad on Windows, TextEdit on Mac, or VS Code.
2. Search for `BASE_PRIMITIVES`. You'll see lines like `primary: { 50: '#EEF2FF', … 600: '#4F46E5' }`.
3. Replace the hex codes with your own. Change only what's between the quote marks.
4. For the font, search for `FONT_FAMILY = 'Inter'`, replace `Inter` with your font's exact name, and save.

COLOR GROUP	USED FOR	KEY SHADE
primary	Main brand color: buttons, links, focus borders	600
neutral	Backgrounds, text and borders	0 (white), 900 (darkest)
danger	Errors and delete actions	600
success	Positive messages and badges	600
warning	Caution messages and badges	600

TIP Lower numbers (50, 100) are light shades; higher numbers (700, 900) are dark. Your font must already be installed on your computer or available in Figma.

03 STEP THREE · ONCE ONLY
Load the plugin into Figma

You do this only once. After that, the plugin stays in your Figma menu.

1. Open the **Figma desktop app**.
2. Create a **new, empty design file** and name it something like **My Design System**.
3. Click the **Figma menu**, the Figma logo at the top left.
4. Go to `Plugins` → `Development` → `Import plugin from manifest...`
5. Find your **DS Builder Components** folder, select **manifest.json** and click **Open**.

DONE The plugin is installed. You'll find it under Plugins → Development → **DS Builder – Components**.

04 STEP FOUR · 10 SECONDS
Run the plugin

One click builds the whole design system in about 5 to 10 seconds.

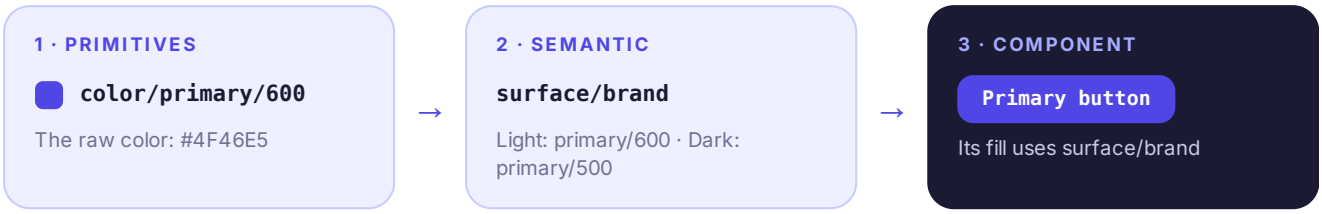
1. Make sure you're in your new **My Design System** file.
2. Open `Figma menu` → `Plugins` → `Development` → `DS Builder – Components`
3. Wait, and don't click anything while it works.
4. A message appears at the bottom of the screen: **"Design system components created"**. Figma then zooms to your new components.

RUN ONCE Running it again in the same file adds a second copy of every component. To start over, delete the components first or use a new empty file.

ERROR? If you see a message starting with **Error**, jump to the Troubleshooting page.

05 STEP FIVE · 2 MINUTES
Check what was created

A quick check confirms everything is connected properly. Tick each item as you go.



How the colors connect: change the raw color in step 1 and everything to the right updates by itself.

- [ ] **On the page**
  Button, Input, Checkbox, Radio, Toggle, Badge, Alert and Card, stacked top to bottom, each inside a purple dashed box. That box means it's a component with options.

- [ ] **Colors**
  Click empty canvas and open **Local variables** in the right panel. You'll see Primitives, Semantic (with Light and Dark columns) and Dimensions.

- [ ] **Text styles**
  In the right panel under Text styles: Display, Heading, Body and Label.

- [ ] **Connections**
  Click any button. Its fill shows a name like `surface/brand` instead of a hex code, so it's linked to your saved colors.

- [ ] **Dark mode (paid plans)**
  Select a frame, find Layer in the right panel, and switch Semantic to Dark. Everything inside turns dark.

06 STEP SIX · EVERYDAY USE
Use the components in your designs

Drag a component in, then change it from the right panel. Avoid editing the originals on the system page, unless you want every copy to change.

1. Create a new page or frame for your screen design.
2. Open the **Assets** panel on the left, next to Layers.
3. Drag a component, for example **Button**, onto your frame.
4. With it selected, change its options in the **right panel**.

COMPONENT	DROPDOWNS	TEXT YOU CAN TYPE	ON / OFF SWITCHES
Button	Type · Size · State	Label	—
Input	State	Label · Placeholder · Helper text	Show helper
Checkbox	Checked · State	Label	—
Radio	Checked · State	Label	—
Toggle	Checked · State	Label	Show label
Badge	Type	Label	—
Alert	Type	Title · Description	—
Card	—	Title · Description	Show image · Show button

TIP To change a color everywhere, open Local variables, find it in Primitives and change its hex code. Every component using it updates instantly.

07 STEP SEVEN · PAID PLANS
Publish as a team library

Publishing turns this file into a shared library, so every project file can use the same components and colors. It needs a Professional plan or higher, and the file must be in a team project, not Drafts.

Publish it

1. Move the file into a team project if it's in Drafts.
2. Open **Assets** and click the **book icon**.
3. Next to your file name, click **Publish**.
4. Add a note such as "First version" and publish.

Use it in another file

1. Open any other design file.
2. In **Assets**, click the **book icon**.
3. Turn on **My Design System**.
4. Your components now appear in Assets.

UPDATES When you change the library later, click Publish again. Other files show "Updates available"; clicking Update brings the changes in.

TROUBLESHOOTING

If something goes wrong

Most problems come from the browser version, an old file, or renamed files.

WHAT YOU SEE	WHY	HOW TO FIX IT
No "Development" option in the Plugins menu	You're using Figma in the browser	Open the Figma desktop app instead
Can't find the file to import	Files are in different folders or renamed	Put `code.js` and `manifest.json` in one folder, with original names
Error: Run Step 1 (DS Builder) in this file first	You're using the old `code.js`	Download the latest `code.js` from Claude and replace the old one
"Your Figma plan allows 1 mode only"	Free plan has no Dark mode	Nothing to fix. Everything else works
Error mentioning a font	Your custom font isn't installed	Install the font, restart Figma and run again
Two copies of every component	The plugin ran twice in one file	Delete the extra copies, or start in a new file
Broken after editing `code.js`	A quote mark or comma was deleted	Download a fresh `code.js` and redo the color changes
No Publish button	File in Drafts, or free plan	Move to a team project; publishing needs a Professional plan

STILL STUCK Take a screenshot of the error and send it to Claude. It will fix the plugin for you.

WHAT'S NEXT

Grow the system, one group at a time

Each new group comes as a fresh `code.js` that you run the same way as Step 4, in the same file.

Navigation

Top bar, side menu, tabs, breadcrumbs, pagination.

For app and website layouts

Popups

Modal dialog, tooltip, dropdown menu, toast message.

For confirmations, menus and quick feedback

Data display

Table, list item, avatar, progress bar.

For dashboards and admin screens

Full screens

Login, sign-up, settings, empty state.

Ready starting points for real projects

Ready for the next group?

Tell Claude which group you want, and you'll get a new recipe file within minutes.

"Add the Navigation components."